

Viable Games in Esports

When it comes to the Esports scene there are various criteria that a video game must meet in order to make it viable. The top three criteria are competitiveness, viewership and funding. For starters, any game that does not exhibit some form of competitiveness is automatically disqualified. “Cozy” games like Animal Crossing, Stardew Valley and some others would not be viable for esports due to the fact that they are more suited for the relaxation of their target demographic as opposed to building a competitive scene.

The next requirement to be considered as viable for Esports would be viewership. Not only does there need to be a solid and large fanbase, but they need to be able to feel as if they have a general understanding of the mechanics and gameplay. One such game that failed in this department, and in a few others, was Paragon. For those that are unfamiliar Paragon is a MOBA that was created by Epic Games, the same company that created Fortnite. Paragon had great potential for the esports scene. It had the funding, the competitiveness but what was really lacking was the viewership. Right around the time that Paragon started gaining traction Fortnite started to really become popular. Since Fortnite is a game that hits all three requirements along with having a consistently growing fanbase from ages all the way from 6 and up Paragon ended up being cancelled completely while Epic turned all of their resources towards Fortnite. Paragon has since been bought by another company and is now renamed as “Fault” and can be found on Steam.

The last condition that must be met is funding. Without proper funding it makes it extremely difficult for a game to grow. Unfortunately, there are many aspects of building a video game that require funding such as game development, marketing, tournaments, and more. Without proper funding you run the risk of your game becoming stagnant and even with the viewership and competitiveness you will not be as successful.

All in all, these are the three major factors in a game being considered as viable for the Esports scene and as you can see they each play a very important role in the success of the game.